

Lucid Dream Control Questionnaire (LDCQ)

About this Questionnaire

A lucid dream is a dream during which you are aware of being in a dream and may involve control of the dream content and events. The Lucid Dream Control Questionnaire (LDCQ) assesses your perceived ability to deliberately and successfully control different aspects of your lucid dreams. The questionnaire contains 36 items that cover seven core domains of dream control: own cognition, own emotion, own body, own movement, dream characters, dream environment, and dream physics. Completion takes 10-15 minutes.

How to Respond

For each statement, indicate how often you are typically able to deliberately and successfully achieve the described form of dream control. Use the following scale:

Never = 0; Rarely = 1; Sometimes = 2; Often = 3; Always = 4

If you have never attempted a particular type of dream control, mark it as "N.A." (Not Applicable).

Please answer the questions based on your typical lucid dreaming experiences rather than a single dream. There are no right or wrong answers, so please respond as honestly as possible.

Important

Your rating should reflect how often you successfully achieve a particular form of dream control when you intentionally attempt it. For example, selecting "Rarely" (score = 1) means that when you attempt this type of dream control, you rarely succeed. It does not mean that you rarely attempt it. Similarly, selecting "N.A." indicates that you never attempted that form of dream control, it does not imply that you would be unable to perform it.

Calculating and Understanding Your Score

The LDCQ provides two types of scores for each domain:

- **Dream Control Score:** The Dream Control Score reflects your perceived ability to successfully control a particular aspect of your lucid dreams. Scores range from 0 to 1 (0 = no perceived control; 1 = complete perceived control). Higher scores indicate greater perceived dream control ability within that domain.
- **Dream Engagement Score:** The Dream Engagement Score reflects the breadth of dream control behaviours that you have attempted within a domain. Scores range from 0 to 1 (0 = no engagement; 1 = complete engagement). Higher engagement scores indicated greater breadth and lower scores poorer breadth.

Together, Dream Control and Dream Engagement scores can be visualized as a **Dream Control Profile**, providing a multi-dimensional overview of your lucid dreaming abilities and experiences. An automated scoring tool and profile visualization can be accessed here:

<https://bonamino-clarita.github.io/LDCQ-Online-Tool/>

Manual Scoring

Alternatively, you can manually calculate the Dream Control and Dream Engagement scores using the instructions below. The LDCQ contains seven domains comprising different numbers of items:

Dream Control Domain	Number of Items
Own Cognition	7
Own Emotion	4
Own Body	5
Own Movement	6
Dream Characters	5
Dream Environment	4
Dream Physics	5

Each item is scored as follows:

Never = 0; Rarely = 1; Sometimes = 2; Often = 3; Always = 4.

Responses marked as “N.A.” are excluded from scoring and are not treated as 0. Selecting “N.A.” indicates that you have not attempted that form of dream control.

Calculating the Dream Control Score for each Domain

1. Add together all item scores within that domain. Exclude any items marked as “N.A.”. This is your total domain score.
2. Count the number of items you answered within that domain (exclude the “N.A.” responses).
3. Divide the total domain score by the number of answered items multiplied by 4.

The resulting Dream Control Score will range from 0 to 1. Higher scores indicate greater perceived dream control ability within that domain, while lower scores indicate lower perceived control.

Example

Suppose you answered four items within a domain with scores of: 3, 2, 4, and “N.A.”.

1. Your total domains core is: $3 + 2 + 4 = 9$ (“N.A.” is excluded from the scoring).
2. The number of items answered is 3 (“N.A.” is excluded from the count).
3. The Dream Control Score for that domain is: $9 \div (3 \times 4) = 9 \div 12 = 0.75$

This indicates that you successfully achieved 75% of the maximum dream-control score within that domain, suggesting a relatively high level of perceived dream control within that domain.

Calculating the Dream Engagement Score for each Domain

1. Count the number of items within that domain that were not marked as “N.A.”
2. Divide this number by the total number of items in that domain.

The resulting Dream Engagement Score will range from 0 to 1. Higher scores indicate that you have attempted a broader range of dream control behaviours within that domain, while lower scores that fewer behaviours have been attempted.

Example

Suppose you answered four items within a domain with scores of: 3, 2, 4, and “N.A.”.

1. Completed items not marked as “N.A.” = 3
2. Dream engagement score: $3 \div 4 = 0.75$

This indicates that you have attempted 75% of the dream control behaviours represented in that domain.

Own Cognition Control

This set of questions assesses your ability to deliberately control cognitive aspects of your lucid dreams, including setting and remembering intentions, maintaining dream stability and lucidity, and remaining focused on intended goals. Please rate each of the following on a scale from 0-4 where:

Never = 0; Rarely = 1; Sometimes = 2; Often = 3; Always = 4

If have never attempted a particular type of dream control) mark it as “N.A.”.

How often can you deliberately and successfully...

Your Score

1. ...maintain lucidity without waking up?
2. ...remember a pre-set intention while lucid in a dream?
3. ...prolong a lucid dream when it starts to fade or feel unstable?
4. ...remain focused on a chosen goal or task without getting distracted?
5. ...prevent losing lucidity or waking up before completing a desired action or intention?
6. ...experience dream control without major distractions or instability (e.g., struggling to exert control, being distracted by the dream or dream characters)?
7. ...regain focus or control when distractions or instability occur?

Total Domain Score
Exclude the “N.A.” questions

Number of Questions Answered
Exclude the “N.A.” questions

Own Cognition Dream Control Score
Total Domain Score ÷ (No. Questions Answered x 4)

Number of Questions NOT Marked as “N.A.”

Own Cognition Dream Engagement Score
No. of non-“N.A.” questions ÷ 7

Own Emotion Control

This set of questions assess your ability to deliberately manage fear, anxiety, excitement, and other emotions to sustain dream lucidity and control. Please rate each of the following on a scale from 0-4 where:

Never = 0; Rarely = 1; Sometimes = 2; Often = 3; Always = 4

If have never attempted a particular type of dream control) mark it as "N.A."

How often can you deliberately and successfully...

Your Score

- | | |
|---|--|
| 8. ...remain calm and collected in an overwhelming, stressful, or particularly exciting dream scenarios? | |
| 9. ...remove an element that induces fear, stress, or other unwanted emotions? | |
| 10. ...change your emotional state (e.g., induce joy or relaxation)? | |
| 11. ...maintain lucidity and control when experiencing strong emotions (e.g., excitement, fear, frustration)? | |

Total Domain Score
Exclude the "N.A." questions

Number of Questions Answered
Exclude the "N.A." questions

Own Emotion Dream Control Score
Total Domain Score ÷ (No. Questions Answered x 4)

Number of Questions NOT Marked as "N.A."

Own Emotion Dream Engagement Score
No. of non-"N.A." questions ÷ 4

Own Body Control

This set of questions assesses your ability to deliberately control your dream body. This refers to your capacity to change the form and senses of your dream body. Please rate each of the following on a scale from 0-4 where:

Never = 0; Rarely = 1; Sometimes = 2; Often = 3; Always = 4

If have never attempted a particular type of dream control) mark it as "N.A."

How often can you deliberately and successfully...

Your Score

12. ...modify your dream body (e.g., change size, shape, or abilities)?

13. ...shapeshift or transform into another being (e.g., animal, plant, person, fictional character) or inanimate object?

14. ...disable or alter your visual perception (e.g., black and white vision, looking through binoculars)?

15. ...disable or alter your auditory perception (e.g., make sounds feel louder or softer)?

16. ...disable or alter other sensory perception (e.g., intensity or quality of smell, taste, touch)?

Total Domain Score
Exclude the "N.A." questions

Number of Questions Answered
Exclude the "N.A." questions

Own Body Dream Control Score
Total Domain Score ÷ (No. Questions Answered x 4)

Number of Questions NOT Marked as "N.A."

Own Body Dream Engagement Score
No. of non-"N.A." questions ÷ 5

Own Movement Control

This set of questions assesses your ability to deliberately control the movements of your dream body. Please rate each of the following on a scale from 0-4 where:

Never = 0; Rarely = 1; Sometimes = 2; Often = 3; Always = 4

If have never attempted a particular type of dream control) mark it as “N.A.”.

How often can you deliberately and successfully...

Your Score

17. ...perform fine motor actions with precision, such as writing, playing an instrument, or using tools?

18. ...perform athletic movements with ease such as sprinting, climbing, or gymnastics?

19. ...maintain balance while performing actions like jumping, standing on one foot, or walking on narrow surfaces?

20. ...take-off, fly, and control your flight direction and altitude (e.g., turning mid-air, adjusting speed, stopping)?

21. ...float (not fly)?

22. ...perform coordinated motor actions with other dream characters (e.g., dancing, flighting, playing sports together)?

Total Domain Score
Exclude the “N.A.” questions

Number of Questions Answered
Exclude the “N.A.” questions

Own Movement Dream Control Score
Total Domain Score ÷ (No. Questions Answered x 4)

Number of Questions NOT Marked as “N.A.”

Own Movement Dream Engagement Score
No. of non-“N.A.” questions ÷ 6

Dream Characters Control

This set of questions assesses your ability to deliberately summon, communicate with, or modify dream characters (including humans, animals, or other beings). Please rate each of the following on a scale from 0-4 where:

Never = 0; Rarely = 1; Sometimes = 2; Often = 3; Always = 4

If have never attempted a particular type of dream control) mark it as “N.A.”.

How often can you deliberately and successfully...

Your Score

23. ...summon or remove a specific dream character?

24. ...alter the appearance of a dream character (e.g., change their clothes, height, hair, other physical features)?

25. ...alter the behaviour of a dream character (e.g., ordering them to complete an action or behave in a specific way)?

26. ...have a casual conversation with a dream character (e.g., exchanging greetings or small talk)?

27. ... have a deep conversation with a dream character (e.g., seeking life advice, new knowledge, solving a problem)?

Total Domain Score
Exclude the “N.A.” questions

Number of Questions Answered
Exclude the “N.A.” questions

Dream Characters Control Score
Total Domain Score ÷ (No. Questions Answered x 4)

Number of Questions NOT Marked as “N.A.”

Dream Characters Engagement Score
No. of non-“N.A.” questions ÷ 5

Dream Environment Control

This set of questions assesses your ability to deliberately to alter settings, objects, and weather and lighting conditions within a lucid dream. Please rate each of the following on a scale from 0-4 where:

Never = 0; Rarely = 1; Sometimes = 2; Often = 3; Always = 4

If have never attempted a particular type of dream control) mark it as “N.A.”.

How often can you deliberately and successfully...

Your Score

28. ...travel to another location by actively changing your surroundings (e.g., teleporting, using a portal, turning around, turning corners, wishing it into)?

29. ...alter the weather or climate (e.g., making it rain or snow)?

30. ...create or remove objects (e.g., trees, buildings, specific elements of your surroundings)?

31. ...control the lighting (e.g., make the dream space brighter or darker, changing the hue/color?)

Total Domain Score

Exclude the “N.A.” questions

Number of Questions Answered

Exclude the “N.A.” questions

Dream Environment Control Score

Total Domain Score ÷ (No. Questions Answered x 4)

Number of Questions NOT Marked as “N.A.”

Dream Environment Engagement Score

No. of non-“N.A.” questions ÷ 4

Dream Physics Control

This set of questions assesses your ability to deliberately summon, communicate with, or modify dream characters (including humans, animals, or other beings). Please rate each of the following on a scale from 0-4 where:

Never = 0; Rarely = 1; Sometimes = 2; Often = 3; Always = 4

If have never attempted a particular type of dream control) mark it as “N.A.”.

How often can you deliberately and successfully...

Your Score

32. ...alter the passage of time (e.g., speed up, slow down, pause, rewind time)?

33. ...modify gravity (e.g., making objects, yourself, or others float or fly, reducing or increasing gravity)?

34. ...switch viewpoint (e.g., from first-person to observer perspective)?

35. ...pass through solid objects or walls?

36. ...change the fundamental properties of objects or your surroundings (e.g., density, solidity)?

Total Domain Score
Exclude the “N.A.” questions

Number of Questions Answered
Exclude the “N.A.” questions

Dream Physics Control Score
Total Domain Score ÷ (No. Questions Answered x 4)

Number of Questions NOT Marked as “N.A.”

Dream Physics Engagement Score
No. of non-“N.A.” questions ÷ 5